

Northwind Billing — On-Call Runbook

Failed charges

When a charge fails, the Payments Service emits a `payment_failed` event. The Dunning Worker retries the charge up to 3 times with exponential backoff (1 hour, 6 hours, 24 hours). After the third failed retry, the subscription is marked `past_due` and the Notifications Service emails the customer. If the account remains `past_due` for 7 days, it is automatically suspended.

Refunds

Refunds are issued through the Payments Service admin API. Refunds above \$500 require approval from a Finance team lead. All refunds are logged to the `audit_log` table in `payments_db` and reflected in Stripe within 24 hours.

Escalation

The billing on-call rotation is owned by the Payments team. The primary on-call responds within 15 minutes during business hours and within 30 minutes off-hours. Page the on-call via PagerDuty service 'northwind-billing'. For Stripe outages, escalate to the Payments team lead, Dana Whitfield, and post an update in the `#billing-incidents` Slack channel.

Key metrics

The billing dashboard tracks charge success rate (target: above 97%), average time to first retry, and `past_due` account count. An alert fires if the charge success rate drops below 95% over any 30-minute window.